YOUR MEDIA SYSTEM

Tony / October 7, 2026 / Version 1.1 / External-server access is a primary path, not a backup.

ACCESS FIRST + MEDIA INTAKE

1 EXTERNAL SERVER / PROVIDER

Flow: Authorized provider → account → player → screen. No home NAS required.

Account control: Five shared connections ≠ five logins. Provider must issue independent identities.

Proof: Disable customer C; A/B/D/E continue. Test old tokens and active sessions.

Failure check: Same lawful source in two players separates app trouble from upstream trouble.

2 FLIX PRO PLAYER ALTERNATIVES

Free-first: VLC, Kodi, IPTVnator, SS IPTV: playback, not upstream provisioning.

More options: Televizo, TiviMate, iMPlayer, Smarters Pro, SmartOne IPTV, IBO Player.

Management: Device/playlist configuration is not revocation of a shared provider password.

Different category: Plex, Jellyfin and Emby need the matching remote host and account model.

3 TWENTY WAYS TO OBTAIN MEDIA

Discs / recording: DVD, Blu-ray, tuner, camera, home tape and screen capture; rights and DRM matter.

Downloadable files: Archive, Library of Congress, NASA, music stores, creator/RSS/cloud/USB delivery.

Streaming access: Tubi, paid services, server invitations and licensed IPTV remain upstream.

Intake: Approved file → verify identity/quality → organize → protect → scan into library.

4 TORRENTS + COMMUNITY RESEARCH

Software chain: Prowlarr → Sonarr TV / Radarr movies → qBittorrent → verified files.

Sources studied: Archive, 1337x, Nyaa.si, TorrentLeech, EZTV, YTS; permissions vary by item.

Evidence limits: Five maintained integrations checked; no live download test or universal Reddit consensus.

Guardrails: Official app downloads; seeding/cleanup policy; VPN-interface test. Usenet is separate.

TONY'S MEDIA SYSTEM

Access · Own · Hybrid

Player ≠ server ≠ account manager

One catalog ≠ one storage pool

OWNED LIBRARY + DELIVERY

5 STORAGE THAT FITS THE JOB

Starting design: AS6810T: 10 HDD bays + 10GbE; 4 approved CMR drives, RAID6; separate Intel host.

Capacity: 10 × 26 TB = 260 raw → 208 after parity → 166.4 TB working at 20% headroom.

Protection: RAID ≠ backup. UPS, health checks, free space and restore-tested originals/configuration.

Buying gate: Only one clearly current exact-ten fit verified. Eight-/12-bay alternatives are labelled.

6 GROW BEYOND ONE BOX

Inside NAS1: Supported disk addition reshapes/rebalances in background; may take days, not a wipe.

Add NAS2: 10Gb network → stable SMB/NFS mounts → one media catalog; storage pools stay separate.

Enclosures: Exact host/shelf match required. AS6004U is USB 5Gbps and shares host failure risk.

Unification: mergerfs can merge a view, not protection. Distributed storage adds real complexity.

7 NETWORK + PLAYBACK

10Gb local path: Matching NAS/host ports, switch, NICs and cables. Local Ethernet ≠ internet upload.

Compute: Direct play: device decodes. Transcode: server converts; GPU, HDR and subtitles matter.

Five viewers: Example: 5 × 8 Mbps needs 40 Mbps payload. Test real 4K/HDR/subtitle combinations.

Server choice: Jellyfin free-first; Plex/Emby after exact-client, paid-feature and account checks.

8 TOOLS + OPERATING CHECKS

Optional helpers: Bazarr subtitles; Seerr requests; Tautulli telemetry; Kometa curation; Tdarr encoding.

PIA routing: Isolate the intended download route. Keep NAS administration private and serving reachable.

Acceptance: Independent users, exact clients, five streams, expansion, NAS2 outage, VPN and restore.

Scope: Finished design and files. Hardware, provider access and actual deployment are not completed.

Print A3 landscape for full-size reading. Complete evidence, prices, platform matrix and 10-model shortlist are in the written report / offline explorer.

26 TB is an illustrative drive size, not a compatibility approval. Arithmetic precedes filesystem overhead. Source websites require internet; the map and explorer do not.